

Module 8: Migration Journey and Experience

Service Learning Project

Accompaniment: Trauma-Informed Support for Newcomer Programs

Overview

After trauma-informed practice training, serve in accompaniment and welcome roles with an organization supporting people who have recently completed difficult migration journeys.

Aligned learning outcomes

- Describe migration stages through service context (UG 1)
- Identify risks migrants face en route and on arrival (UG 2)
- Explain emotional impacts without eliciting them (UG 3)
- Recognize vulnerable groups and appropriate support (UG 4)

Suggested community partners

- Organizations serving recently arrived families (ALAS-model programs)
- Newcomer youth programs (art, recreation, homework help)
- Hospital or clinic navigation programs for new arrivals
- Shelter or transitional housing welcome programs

Project steps

1. Complete mandatory trauma-informed engagement training before any community contact (provided in-course or by partner).
2. Serve in low-pressure, presence-based roles: children's activities, welcome kits, transportation help, recreation programs.
3. Keep a reflective practice journal focused on your own responses and skills — never on eliciting others' stories.
4. Build a 'journey-stage service map' of local organizations serving people at arrival, adjustment, and integration stages.
5. Debrief regularly with the site supervisor; practice boundaries and self-care.
6. Final reflection: how trauma-informed principles change what 'helping' means.

Deliverables

- Reflective practice journal (5+ entries)
- Journey-stage service map (partner keeps)
- 3-page final reflection on trauma-informed practice

Time commitment

16–18 hours plus training.

Ethics requirements

Students never solicit migration or trauma narratives. If someone chooses to share, students listen respectfully and follow the partner's response protocol. Mandatory training precedes all contact.

Grading rubric

Each criterion is scored at one of four levels, then weighted as shown. The overall grade is the weighted combination of criterion scores. Instructors may adapt weights and descriptors to local requirements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Demonstrated trauma-informed conduct, per supervisor feedback 35%	Conduct is impeccable: demonstrated trauma-informed conduct, per supervisor feedback is demonstrated throughout, protocols are followed without exception, and the work shows active care for the people and communities involved.	Conduct is sound: demonstrated trauma-informed conduct, per supervisor feedback is evident with only minor lapses that do not affect participants or partners, and all required protocols are followed.	Conduct is uneven: demonstrated trauma-informed conduct, per supervisor feedback is addressed but with gaps — a missed protocol step, careless handling of sensitive material, or boundary issues requiring instructor follow-up.	Conduct falls short of requirements: demonstrated trauma-informed conduct, per supervisor feedback is neglected in ways that required intervention or placed participants, partners, or material at risk.
Consistency and reliability of service 25%	Exceptional professionalism: consistency and reliability of service is confirmed by strong partner or site feedback; the student was consistently prepared, dependable, and left the partner concretely better off.	Solid professionalism: consistency and reliability of service is confirmed by positive partner feedback; commitments were met with only minor scheduling or preparation issues.	Inconsistent professionalism: consistency and reliability of service is partially met — missed sessions, uneven preparation, or partner feedback indicating the student required significant management.	Inadequate professionalism: consistency and reliability of service is not met; commitments were unmet or the partner's experience was negative.
Quality of the service map 20%	The deliverable is excellent: quality of the service map is met at a standard the partner or audience can use immediately — complete, accurate, well-organized, and genuinely useful.	The deliverable is good: quality of the service map is met; it is usable with minor revisions and its purpose is clearly served.	The deliverable is incomplete: quality of the service map is only partly met — gaps, errors, or unclear organization mean substantial revision is needed before it could be used.	The deliverable is inadequate: quality of the service map is not met; the product is unusable, inaccurate, or missing major required elements.
Reflection depth 20%	Reflection is genuinely self-examining: reflection depth shows specific assumptions confronted with evidence, real change or evidenced confirmation, and questions that extend beyond the assignment.	Reflection is substantive: reflection depth shows honest engagement with the student's own thinking, supported by course material, with occasional generality.	Reflection is surface-level: reflection depth is attempted but stays safe or generic — conclusions asserted rather than examined, little connection to evidence.	Reflection is performative or missing: reflection depth shows no genuine self-examination or contradicts the evidence presented.